

REES ATKINS

(208) 293-5745 | reesatkins@gmail.com | Tallahassee, FL

EDUCATION & LICENSURE

FLORIDA STATE UNIVERSITY, Tallahassee, FL

Pursuing a PhD in political science as of August, 2026

SANDRA DAY O'CONNOR COLLEGE OF LAW, ARIZONA STATE UNIVERSITY, Phoenix, AZ

Juris Doctor, *cum laude*, May 2019 - GPA: 3.57; Class Rank: 55/222 (top 25%)

Honors: CALI Award for Highest Grade in the Class in Criminal Law, Paul & Flo Eckstein Scholarship

BRIGHAM YOUNG UNIVERSITY, Provo, Utah

Bachelor of Science in Economics, *cum laude*, Certificate in Spanish, April 2016

GPA: 3.93; Top 10% - Honors: Maurine & Seth Horne Scholarship (full tuition academic scholarship)

IDAHO STATE BAR, ISB #10917, Admitted to Idaho Supreme Court and U.S. District Court, District of Idaho

EXPERIENCE

PUBLIC DEFENDER, MINI-CASSIA OFFICE, Burley, ID, Feb 2021-March 2022, Oct 2023-July 2026

Deputy Public Defender

- Represent defendants accused by prosecutors in two counties
- Advocate for juveniles, including 25+ contested evidentiary hearings
- Draft documents and argue successfully at hearings for motions to suppress and appeals
- Learn and adapt during transition from county-based to state-wide system of public defense

ECHELON LAW, PLLC, Burley, ID, Jan 2023-Sep 2023

Associate Attorney

- Represented immigrants in applications for immigration benefits, with immigration trainings in Florida and Arizona
- Negotiated and litigated child support cases for the State of Idaho
- Represented clients against charges from the government under a contract for all juvenile cases for the Mini-Cassia Public Defender's Office, appointment by courts for conflict work, and private retainers

PARSONS, LOVELAND, SHIRLEY & LINDSTROM, LLP, Burley, ID, March 2022-Jan 2023

Associate Attorney

- Prosecuted criminal cases for the City of Burley
- Negotiated and litigated family, contract, negligence, and property cases
- Researched and briefed answers to questions from senior partners

5TH JUDICIAL DISTRICT OF IDAHO, Twin Falls, ID, Aug 2019-Feb 2021

Law Clerk to District Judge Benjamin Cluff

- Researched and drafted orders and memorandums regarding both civil and criminal matters
- Formalized judgments of conviction and wrote notes to prepare the judge for proceedings

ARIZONA STATE SENATE, Phoenix, AZ, Jan-May 2019

Legal Intern

- Reviewed incoming bills for constitutional issues such as contract interference, special legislation, and elections
- Researched Arizona, 9th Cir., and U.S. S. Ct. case law and wrote memos with my conclusions on bills' constitutionality
- Noted constitutional issues that arose at committee meetings and reported them to my supervisor

FEDERAL IMMIGRATION COUNSELORS, Phoenix, AZ, May-Dec 2018

Legal Intern

- Drafted documents such as requests for bond and briefs explaining asylum claims

REES ATKINS

(208) 293-5745 | reesatkins@gmail.com | Tallahassee, FL

- Wrote Motions to Reopen during a shift in the law resulting from a Supreme Court decision
- Communicated with clients in and out of detention facilities to prepare forms and explain the legal process

ARIZONA STATE UNIVERSITY, Phoenix, AZ, 2018

Research Assistant to Prof. Bijal Shah, May-July 2018

- Researched the origin of the Attorney General's Office and its relationship to the President
- Compiled research for the professor in a succinct, logical, and complete manner
- Created an extensive database of cases involving intergovernmental litigation
- Contributed to and received mention in the professor's paper *Executive Administration*, 72 STAN. L. REV. 641 (2020)

Teaching Assistant, Criminal Law, Jan-April 2018

- Graded assignments and gave individual feedback and tutoring
- Led reviews to summarize class content and prepare for exams

SCHRAMM, WILLIAMS & ASSOCIATES, Washington, D.C., Sept-Dec 2015

Intern

- Researched legislation and the federal register to advise pistachio producers about effects of the Iran trade deal
- Drafted and published articles on agricultural products on firm website

BRIGHAM YOUNG UNIVERSITY, Provo, UT, 2013-2016

Research Assistant to Econ. Prof. Brigham Frandsen, April-Aug 2015

- Analyzed effects of laws protecting public sector labor unions' ability to collectively bargain using STATA software
- Researched old newspapers regarding public sector labor unions and summarized information

Teaching Assistant, Statistics for Economists, April-June 2015

- Taught and reinforced statistics concepts to help individuals with questions
- Created online assignments to allow students to have immediate feedback

Teaching Assistant, American Heritage, September 2013-April 2016

- Taught a class 2-3 times each week about history, economics, and politics, and attended lectures led by professor
- Graded papers for 60 students to ensure accurate and clear understanding of concepts
- Tutored students to set and achieve academic goals

PUBLICATIONS

- Crimmigration Is Complicated, But a Little Research Goes a Long Way. (2024, November). *The Advocate*, 40.
- Immigration and the Best Interests of Children. (2023, November). *The Advocate*, 50.
- OSHA and you. (2020, July). *Ag Proud*, 25.

LANGUAGES

- Fluent in Spanish (verbal and written)
- Beginning learner of Chinese

COMMUNITY OUTREACH

- Mentoring visits monthly to youth in the juvenile detention center, including singing with family (2022-July 2026)
- Taught citizenship classes to refugees for a year to help them become citizens (2016-2017)
- Interpreted for other volunteers as part of an education trip to Guatemala with Humanize Expeditions (July 2014)
- Missionary – The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, Guatemala (June 2011-June 2013)
- Working in unity with, visiting, and teaching those in church congregation (2010-present)